

Gorilla Fact File ■

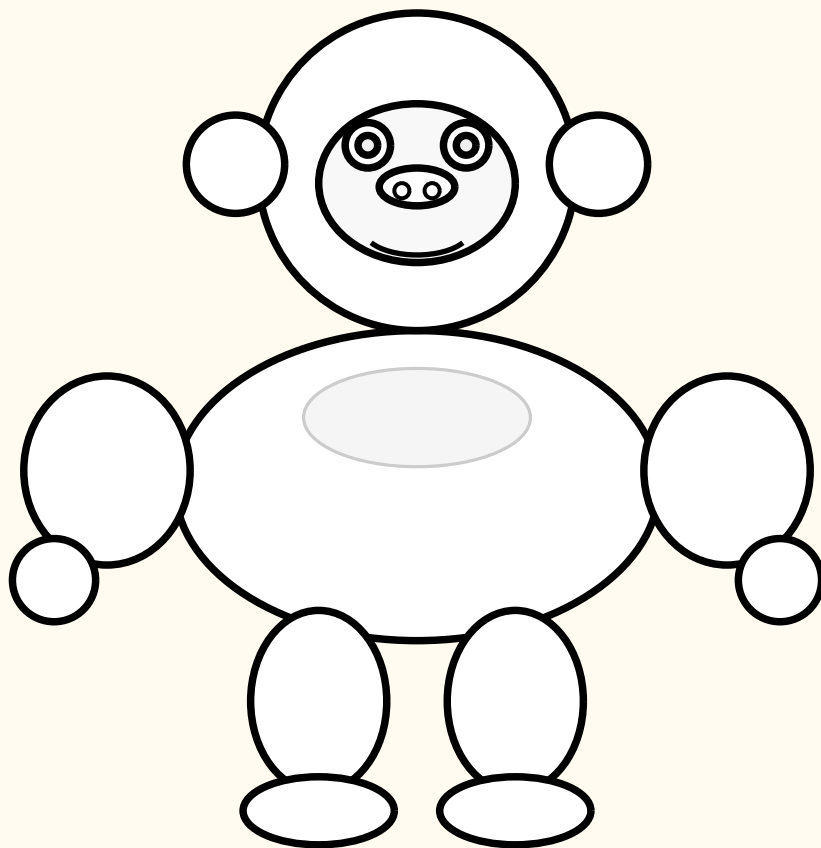
Scientific name:	Gorilla beringei / Gorilla gorilla
Conservation status:	Critically Endangered
Where they live:	DR Congo, Uganda, Rwanda, Cameroon, Gabon
Habitat:	Tropical rainforests and mountain forests of Central Africa
Diet:	Herbivore — leaves, stems, fruit, bark, and roots
Weight:	135–220 kg (male), 70–90 kg (female)
Lifespan:	35–40 years in the wild
Population:	Fewer than 1,100 mountain gorillas remain

Did You Know? ■

- Gorillas share 98.3% of their DNA with humans — our closest relatives after chimps!
- A silverback gorilla has a distinctive silver-grey patch on its back.
- Gorillas build a brand new sleeping nest from branches every single night.
- Mountain gorillas live at altitudes up to 4,500 m — higher than most aeroplanes cruise!
- A gorilla's 'threat display' includes chest-beating, but they rarely actually fight.
- Gorillas communicate using at least 25 distinct vocalisations.

Color Me! — Gorilla

How many colours can you use?



Did you know? Silverbacks have a grey patch that grows as they age.

Activity Worksheets

Word Search — find all 8 words!

C	Y	O	K	P	K	R	Y	J	W	A	H
E	W	Q	P	C	Y	Y	G	R	X	K	M
A	F	R	I	C	A	F	I	Y	P	F	Z
C	O	N	S	E	R	V	A	T	I	O	N
T	E	N	D	A	N	G	E	R	E	D	X
W	Z	Z	K	M	T	I	Y	B	J	U	Q
Y	X	R	A	I	N	F	O	R	E	S	T
U	C	Y	H	Z	G	O	R	I	L	L	A
S	I	L	V	E	R	B	A	C	K	B	W
C	E	N	U	J	G	P	Q	R	S	D	N
U	T	H	A	B	I	T	A	T	X	L	B
U	V	K	J	P	R	I	M	A	T	E	Z

Words to find:

GORILLA	SILVERBACK	RAINFOREST	ENDANGERED
AFRICA	PRIMATE	HABITAT	CONSERVATION

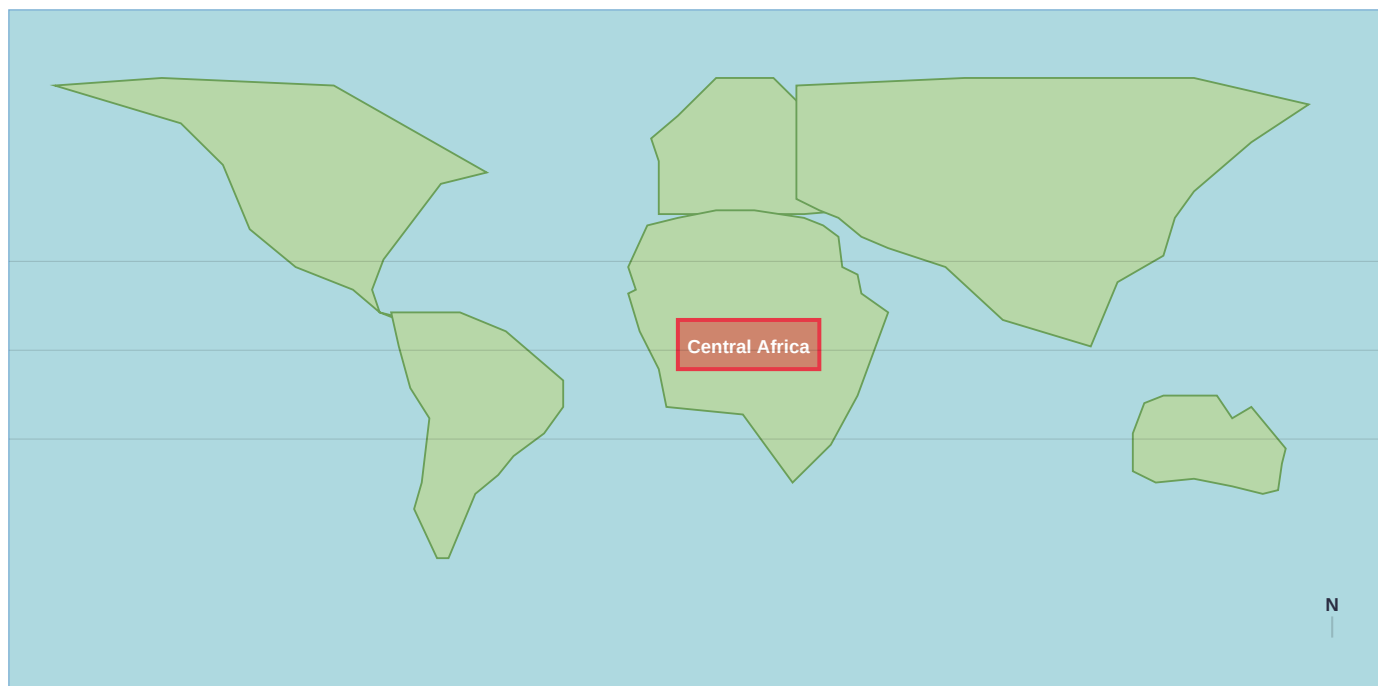
Fill in the Blanks!

- Gorillas live in _____ in Central Africa.
- A male gorilla leader is called a _____.
- Gorillas share ____% of their DNA with humans.
- Mountain gorillas are _____ Endangered.
- Gorillas build a new sleeping _____ every night.
- Gorillas are important _____ dispersers in the forest.

Answers: rainforests | Silverback | 98.3 | Critically | nest | seed

Habitat Map & Poster ■■

Gorillas live in DR Congo, Uganda, Rwanda, Cameroon, Gabon. The highlighted area shows their range. Can you find it on the map? Label the surrounding countries!



Biome Breakdown

Biome:	Tropical Rainforest / Montane Forest
Annual rain:	1,500 – 3,000 mm per year
Temperature:	15 – 29 °C (varies with altitude)
Canopy height:	Up to 50 m in lowland areas
Key plants:	Figs, wild celery, thistles, bamboo (mountain gorillas)

Annotation Challenge:

Using an atlas or globe, can you add these labels to the map above? DR Congo • Uganda • Rwanda • Atlantic Ocean • Indian Ocean • Equator

STEM Challenge: Knuckle-Walking Physics ■

Question: Why do gorillas walk on their knuckles instead of their palms?

Materials:

- A heavy book
- Your hands

Steps:

1. Try walking on all fours with your palms flat on the floor for 30 seconds.
2. Now try the same thing but curl your fingers and walk on your knuckles.
3. Which feels stronger and more stable? Which puts less strain on your wrists?
4. Measure how far you can 'walk' in 10 seconds both ways.

Record Your Results:

Method	Time (10 secs)	Comfort rating (1–5)	Notes
Flat palms			
Knuckle-walking			

Science behind it: Knuckle-walking transfers weight through the strong finger bones rather than the flexible wrist. Gorillas' curved finger bones lock together when they make a fist, creating a rigid, weight-bearing column — like a natural walking stick.

Writing Prompts ■

Choose one prompt and write your story or answer below.

You wake up as a young gorilla deep in the rainforest. The morning mist swirls around the trees. Your silverback father beats his chest in the distance...

A wildlife ranger has just spotted a poacher near the gorilla troop. You are the ranger. Describe what you do next...

My Conservation Pledge 🐼■

I, _____, promise to help protect gorillas by:

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